RELIEF / SUBSTITUTE TEACHER PACK

💧 Water Safety — Relief Teacher Pack

Everything you need to run a complete 50-minute lesson on water safety. No specialist HPE knowledge required. All materials and instructions are included.

Year 7–8 HPE | No prep needed | 50-min self-contained lesson | Scenario card activity | Recording sheet included

⚡ Quick Start — What You Need to Know

Students are partway through a Year 7–8 water safety unit. This lesson uses scenario cards as a structured group activity. You do not need water safety expertise — just follow the script below.

50
Minutes — this lesson is timed and self-contained

6
Scenario card groups — all instructions on the cards

0
Specialist HPE knowledge required from you

📌 About This Unit

Students are studying the Swim & Water Safety unit in Health & Physical Education. They have covered (or are covering) beach flags, rip currents, DRS ABCD emergency response, SwimSafe rules, and hazard identification. Today's lesson reinforces this content through a structured scenario card activity and class discussion.

⚠️ Class Information — Check Before Starting

- Check the roll — the class list should be in the teacher's day book or admin office
- Check for any students with medical conditions noted in the roll — no pool or water activities in this lesson
- If students ask about a specific activity from a previous lesson, tell them you will continue where they left off — today is a scenario activity

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- If the class is difficult to settle, use the "5 Questions" warm-up (see Lesson Plan below) immediately

📋 Lesson Plan — 50 Minutes

Water Safety Scenario Card Activity

`Year 7–8 · 50 min · No resources needed beyond this pack`

`0–5 min`

Roll & Settle

Mark the roll. While doing so, write on the board: **"Think of ONE water safety rule you already know. We'll share these in 2 minutes."** This gives students something to do while you mark the roll and buys you settle time.

`5–12 min`

Warm-Up — "5 Questions" Rapid Fire

Read these questions aloud. Students call out or show hands. No wrong answers — just activating what they know.

1. What does the red and yellow flag mean at the beach? *(Always swim here — patrolled zone)*
2. What does DRS stand for in DRS ABCD? *(Danger, Response, Send for help)*
3. What is the first thing you do if caught in a rip current? *(Stay calm, float, don't fight it)*
4. What is the emergency number in Australia? *(000)*
5. What does "Throw, Don't Go" mean? *(Throw something to a drowning person — don't jump in yourself)*

`12–16 min`

Scenario Card Activity — Setup

Divide the class into 6 groups (3–5 students per group). Hand each group one scenario card from the set below — you can print or just read each card aloud to the group.

Tell students: **"Your group has 15 minutes to read your scenario, decide what the people in it should do, and prepare a 1-minute explanation for the class. Use what you've learned in this unit."**

Your job during this time: circulate, listen, prompt groups that are stuck. You don't need to provide answers — guide them back to the question if they go off track.

`16–31 min`

Group Preparation Time

Groups work through their scenarios. As you circulate, useful prompting questions if groups are stuck:

- "What are the risks in this situation — list them before you decide what to do"
- "What do the SwimSafe rules say about this?"

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- "Is there a lifeguard here? What does that change?"
- "What would you actually say if you called 000 in this situation?"

31–47 min

Group Presentations — 2.5 Minutes Each

Each group has 2 minutes to present their scenario and their recommendation, plus 30 seconds for questions from the class. You facilitate — no specialist knowledge needed.

Useful class discussion questions after each group:

- "Does everyone agree? What would you do differently?"
- "What is the BIGGEST risk in this scenario?"
- "What happens if they do nothing?"

47–50 min

Exit Ticket + Pack Up

Students write one sentence on a scrap of paper (or in their workbook) before the bell: **"The most important water safety rule is _____ because _____."** Collect these or leave on desks for the classroom teacher. Pack up the scenario cards if you printed them.

🃏 Scenario Cards — Print or Read Aloud to Groups

Print this page and cut out the cards, or simply read each card to the relevant group. Each card contains the scenario and the discussion question.

SCENARIO 1 — THE BEACH

Red Flag Day

Aiden and his friends arrive at a Victorian beach. There is a single red flag flying. His friends say "That just means be careful — let's go in anyway, we're strong swimmers." Aiden is hesitant.

What should Aiden do? What are the risks? What would you say to his friends?

Key concepts: flags, patrolled vs unpatrolled, peer pressure

SCENARIO 2 — THE RIVER

The River After Rain

It's a hot Saturday. Maya and her family drive to a popular river swimming spot. The water is higher and browner than usual after two days of heavy rain. Her younger sister wants to jump in. There are no signs and no lifeguard.

What should Maya say? What are the specific dangers of swimming here today?

Key concepts: inland waterways, cold water, post-rain risk, no supervision

SCENARIO 3 — THE POOL

Not Moving

Jayden is at a friend's backyard pool party. He looks over and sees someone floating face-down. They aren't moving. There are four other people nearby on their phones. No-one is reacting.

SCENARIO 4 — THE RIP

Pulled Out to Sea

Sophie is swimming between the flags at a patrolled beach. She suddenly feels water pulling her strongly away from shore. She's a decent swimmer and her instinct is to swim back to shore as hard as she can.

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Walk through the DRS ABCD steps exactly. What do you do first? What do you say when you call 000?

Key concepts: DRS ABCD, bystander effect, 000, Throw Don't Go

Is Sophie's instinct correct? What should she actually do? What would happen if she followed her instinct?

Key concepts: rip currents, panic response, float and signal, swimming parallel

SCENARIO 5 — THE DAM

The Dare

A group of Year 8 students are at a farm property. Someone dares them to jump off a jetty into a dam "because it's fun and they've all done it before." It's 35 degrees and the water looks cool and calm.

What are the hazards they can't see? What are the SwimSafe rules being broken here? How do you say no to a dare?

Key concepts: hidden hazards, SwimSafe rules, peer pressure, entering feet first

SCENARIO 6 — EXTENSION

The Inflatable

Zoe and her family are at the beach. It's a hot, sunny day with light wind. An orange windsock flag is flying near the surf club. Zoe's younger brother wants to take his inflatable ring into the water. Their parents say it should be fine because "the water looks calm today."

Are the parents right? What does the orange flag specifically mean? What could happen? What should Zoe say?

Key concepts: flags, offshore winds, inflatables, family safety communication

🩺 Quick Reference — DRS ABCD (for your use during discussion)

D	R	S	A	B	C	D
DANGER	RESPONSE	SEND 000	AIRWAY	BREATHING	CPR	DEFIB

🌊 Key Facts — If Students Ask

- **Red & yellow flags:** Always swim here — lifeguard is on duty
- **Single red flag:** Dangerous — experienced swimmers only, extreme caution
- **Orange windsock:** Offshore winds — NO inflatables, they will blow out to sea
- **Rip current:** Don't fight it. Float, swim sideways (parallel to shore), angle back in
- **CPR:** 30 chest compressions + 2 breaths. Hard and fast (~100 beats per minute)
- **SwimSafe 5 rules:** Read signs · Enter feet first · Stay in depth · Swim with a friend · Signal for help
- **If drowning:** Throw, Don't Go — throw a rope, towel, or floatable item first. Untrained rescuers drown too.

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📄 Recording Sheet — Leave for the Classroom Teacher

Relief Teacher Report — Water Safety Lesson

DATE _____ CLASS _____ RELIEF TEACHER NAME _____

LESSON COMPLETED? (CIRCLE)

Yes — fully Yes — partially No

STUDENTS ABSENT (NAMES): _____

Scenario Group	Students (names or numbers)	How the group went — notes for the classroom teacher
Scenario 1 — Red Flag Day		
Scenario 2 — River After Rain		
Scenario 3 — Not Moving		
Scenario 4 — Pulled Out to Sea		
Scenario 5 — The Dare		
Scenario 6 — Extension		

ANY BEHAVIOUR OR WELFARE CONCERNS TO NOTE:

Write here if relevant...

EXIT TICKET SUMMARY (LEAVE IF COLLECTED, OR NOTE KEY THEMES):

Write here if relevant...

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